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Chapter 5

Utilities



Sub-systems

In order to maximise the speed at which orders are accepted via Drinks Telesales, and to control the automatic scheduling of calls, certain functions run in a separate Drinks Telesales sub-system. These functions are known as 'sleepers' and are activated when required.

The menu options for the sub-system are located in the Drinks Telesales Utilities menu.

The functions of the sub-system are as follows:

Automatic Call Re-scheduler

Every 10 minutes, this 'sleeper' receives a call from the Sub-system controller to review the call lists and decide whether or not calls have expired by time and whether they can be re-scheduled to a later time. Operator requests for re-scheduling (from Order Entry) are also processed

Standard Order Bank Update

On closing a call, this 'sleeper' is activated and the order is written to the standard order bank. Once accepted these orders may be treated as an order in the Drinks Sales Order Processing base module.

Subsystem Controller

At the beginning of the working day, when this option is taken, a request is sent to the Order Bank Update, for every Drinks Telesales company, to update any outstanding orders.

A request is also sent to the Automatic Call Re-scheduler every ten minutes, to re-schedule any overdue timed calls.

Sub-System Jobs

The background jobs run in a sub-system, DSBACK3, which is activated using 'Start Background Subsystem' option.



Note: The subsystem has to be started and active before the background jobs can be started.

It is common to build the 'Start Sub-system' option into an automatic start-of-day job, hence avoiding the necessity of running it manually. [The subsystem description for DSBACK3 can be found in the Drinks Telesales program menu.]

At the end of the day, or the end of the Telesales session, firstly the background jobs, and then the sub-system, should be ended. Use the 'End Background Subsystem' option.



Note: Ending the background subsystem is the only way to end the sub-system controller job. This will also close down the Automatic Call Rescheduler.

Background Jobs

Once the sub-system has been started, each of the background jobs can be started:

- **Start Automatic Call Re-scheduler** - This should be used if the dynamic call re-scheduling functions are required for immediate notification to the Operator(s).
- **Start Order Bank Update** - This should always be used to transfer Drinks Telesales orders to the Drinks Sales Order Processing system.
- **Start Subsystem Controller** - This should be started if the ten-minute re-scheduling function is required, or if any outstanding orders ('stuck' in Drinks Telesales) need to be manually transferred to Drinks Sales Order Processing.

There are two equivalent tasks in Drinks Telesales Utilities to end the background jobs:

- **End Automatic Call Re-scheduler** - This should be run if call re-scheduling is no longer required during the day. It is not required if the End Background Sub-system option is taken (since the latter option also closes down the Automatic Call Re-scheduler).
- **End Order Bank Update** - This should be run at the end of the day, before the End Background Sub-system option is taken.



Note: There is no specific task to 'end' the Sub-system Controller - this can only be done by taking the End Background Sub-system option (after ending all the Background Jobs, above).

Refresh Price List



51/DSU

This utility submits a batch job to refresh all existing buying lists with Price List Sequence Codes from the Inventory Item Master File. This is needed because the Codes are used to re-structure History Buying Lists into Product Groups.

The Price List Sequence Code is taken from the Item at the time the Buying List is created, so, if the sequence code is changed on the item master, it needs to be reflected on all existing buying lists, re-sequencing them, as required, into their respective new Groups.

A standard text window is displayed, allowing you to confirm or reject your choice.



Press **F8=Submit** to confirm submission of the update process.

Mass Update of Call Profiles



52/DSU

This utility submits a batch job to change all call profiles from one operator to another.

Mass Update of Call Profiles Screen



Select the Mass Update Of Call Profiles option.

TS485	HW - Handy Wholesalers Ltd	User: GALBRAIJ	17/11/95
			16:55:52
Mass Change of Call Profiles			
From operator code...?.. 2501 Janette Galbraith			
To operator code....?.. 2119 Georgina Davies			
F3=Exit F8=Submit F12=Previous			
01-02 SF MW KS IM II KENB20A PED170S1			

Fields:

Operator Code Range

Enter 'From' and 'To' operators, for whom the transfer is to take place.



Press **F8=Submit** to submit the batch job to perform the transfer.

Auto Submit - Call List Generation



53/DSU

This utility submits a batch job to create the call lists.

When run at the end of the week (Sunday) all outstanding calls for the previous week are cleared and a full schedule for the new week is generated.

When run on any other day of the week, only the calls for the next day are rebuilt.

This job would normally be built into the End of Day automatic Job Scheduling.



Select the Auto Submit - Call List Generation option.

A standard text window is displayed, allowing you to confirm or reject your choice.



Press **F8=Submit** to confirm submission of the update process.